

AtmosFlow

Indoor Air Quality Assessment

by Prudence Safety & Environmental Consulting, LLC

Screening-Level IAQ Assessment Report

Direct-reading evaluation of carbon dioxide, comfort, and particulate / VOC indicators

SAMPLE — EVALUATION USE ONLY

FACILITY	Meridian Commerce Tower (sample)
ADDRESS	1450 Asherton Park Drive, Suite 600, Calverton Heights, MD 20899
SCOPE	Floors 7, 8, and 12
ASSESSMENT DATE	March 14, 2026
ASSESSOR OF RECORD	John Smith, CIH, CSP
REPORT ID	PSEC-IAQ-2026-0314-MCT

This document is a fictitious sample produced to illustrate AtmosFlow report structure and tone. All facility identifiers, measurements, and personnel are invented and do not describe a real building or assessment.

Screening-level evaluation — not a regulatory exposure determination, OSHA compliance certification, or medical evaluation.

Executive Summary

On March 14, 2026, Prudence Safety & Environmental Consulting, LLC conducted a screening-level indoor air quality (IAQ) assessment of floors 7, 8, and 12 at Meridian Commerce Tower (sample). The assessment combined direct-reading instrument measurements with visual inspection and occupant interviews across eight representative zones during normal occupied-hours operation. Its purpose is to characterize ventilation adequacy, thermal comfort, and common airborne indicators, and to prioritize follow-up where conditions warrant. This is a screening evaluation; results reflect conditions observed during the assessment window and are interpreted in light of the limitations in Section 7.

FINDINGS AT A GLANCE

Parameter	Site range	Reference basis	Screening outcome
Carbon dioxide (CO ₂)	612–1247 ppm	ASHRAE 62.1 ventilation indicator	Elevated
Carbon monoxide (CO)	0.4–1.1 ppm	US EPA NAAQS 9 ppm (8-hr)	Acceptable
Temperature	70.2–74.9 °F	ASHRAE 55 comfort envelope	Acceptable
Relative humidity	36–51 %	ASHRAE 55 (30–60% target)	Acceptable
Fine particulate (PM _{2.5})	6–18 µg/m ³	US EPA NAAQS 35 µg/m ³ (24-hr)	Advisory
Total VOCs (TVOC)	220–610 µg/m ³	Mølhave (1991) advisory tiers	Advisory

SEVERITY LEGEND

ACCEPTABLE

ADVISORY

ELEVATED

PRIORITY

Acceptable: within recognized screening references. Advisory: monitor / investigate source. Elevated: corrective action recommended. Priority: prompt action recommended.

OVERALL SCREENING STATEMENT

Most zones presented acceptable ventilation, comfort, and air-quality indicators. One interior conference room (Zone 8-D) showed a carbon-dioxide concentration consistent with under-ventilation relative to occupant load during a high-occupancy meeting, and two zones (8-F copy/print room and 12-B break room) showed advisory-tier particulate and VOC readings attributable to identifiable local sources. No carbon-monoxide, thermal, or humidity conditions outside the screening references were observed. Recommended actions in Section 5 are scoped to ventilation balancing on Floor 8 and short-term source control / monitoring elsewhere.

1. Scope & Site Description

The assessment covered floors 7, 8, and 12 of Meridian Commerce Tower (sample), a multi-tenant Class-A office building served by a central variable-air-volume (VAV) HVAC system with rooftop air handlers and perimeter VAV boxes. Eight zones were selected to represent a cross-section of use types: perimeter and interior offices, open workstations, a conference room, a copy/print room, an executive suite, and a break room. Occupancy at the time of assessment ranged from 1 to 6 persons per zone. Outdoor conditions were mild and dry ("H58 °F, 55% RH), with light wind from the northwest.

The objective was a screening characterization of indoor air quality indicators to (a) confirm whether observed conditions fall within recognized comfort and ventilation references, (b) identify any zones warranting follow-up, and (c) provide a defensible, prioritized action list. The assessment did not include integrated time-weighted-average sampling, microbial sampling, or destructive investigation.

Figure 1 — Representative sampling locations (Floor 8 schematic)



● Direct-reading sampling location (S#) · S2 = continuous logger station · Not to scale; layout is schematic.

Schematic of Floor 8 showing the spaces sampled and the direct-reading locations (S1–S3). The interior conference room (8-D) has no operable window and was the continuous-logger station.

2. METHODOLOGY & INSTRUMENTATION

Direct-reading instrumentation

- TSI Q-Trak 7575 multi-parameter monitor + DustTrak DRX 8534. CO₂, CO, temperature, and relative humidity captured with the Q-Trak; fine particulate (PM_{2.5}) captured with the DustTrak DRX.
- Calibration: both instruments bump-checked the morning of the assessment and last factory-calibrated 12 days prior, within manufacturer specification. CO₂ accuracy at 1,000 ppm: ±50 ppm (manufacturer-stated). PM_{2.5} zeroed with a HEPA filter immediately before use.
- Measurement protocol: grab readings at occupied breathing-zone height (1.5 m AGL) held at least 3 minutes per location, with a short continuous log (1-minute interval) in the conference room during an occupied meeting.

Reference framework

Outcomes are screened against recognized consensus and regulatory references: ASHRAE 62.1-2022 (ventilation, used as an indicator basis for CO₂ — not a CO₂ contaminant limit), ASHRAE 55-2020 (thermal comfort), US EPA NAAQS (CO and PM_{2.5}), OSHA PELs (29 CFR 1910.1000), and the Mølhave (1991) advisory tiers for TVOC. References are used to contextualize screening readings, not to render compliance determinations.

3. Measurement Results

The table below summarizes representative occupied-hours readings by zone. The outdoor reference and site arithmetic mean are shown for context. Values are direct-reading grab measurements unless otherwise noted.

Zone	Use	CO2 ppm	CO ppm	T °F	RH %	PM2.5 µg/m ³	TVOC µg/m ³	Outcome
Outdoor	Rooftop intake (reference)	432	0.3	58.0	55	12	50	Acceptable
7-A	South perimeter office	612	0.4	71.8	41	7	220	Acceptable
7-C	Open workstations	740	0.5	72.5	43	9	280	Acceptable
8-B	Open office	905	0.6	73.4	46	11	340	Acceptable
8-D	Interior conference (no operable window)	1247	0.7	74.9	51	14	520	Elevated
8-F	Copy / print room	880	0.6	73.1	44	18	610	Advisory
12-A	Executive suite	690	0.4	72.0	40	6	240	Acceptable
12-B	Break room	1015	1.1	73.8	48	16	430	Advisory
12-D	IT-room-adjacent office	760	0.5	70.2	36	8	300	Acceptable
Site mean		856	0.6	72.7	44	11	368	Acceptable

Site mean is the arithmetic mean of the eight occupied zones (outdoor reference excluded). Outcome reflects the zone's governing parameter.

PER-PARAMETER INTERPRETATION

Each indicator below is introduced briefly — what it is and why it is measured — followed by what was observed at this site and how it compares to recognized references.

Carbon dioxide (CO2) — ventilation indicator

What it is and why we measure it: Carbon dioxide is produced by people as they breathe and builds up indoors when the supply of outdoor air does not keep pace with the number of occupants. At the concentrations typical of offices it is not itself a health hazard, but it is the most practical real-time indicator of ventilation adequacy — elevated levels usually accompany "stuffiness" complaints and signal that a space is receiving too little fresh air for its occupant load.

Observed: Outdoor baseline averaged 432 ppm. Indoor concentrations ranged 612–1247 ppm (site mean 856 ppm). ASHRAE 62.1 prescribes ventilation rates rather than a CO2 limit; an indoor-to-outdoor differential above roughly 700 ppm is commonly used as an indicator of under-ventilation relative to occupant load. The conference-room peak of 1247 ppm in Zone 8-D — captured during a six-person meeting — represents 815 ppm above outdoor baseline, exceeding the indicator by ~115 ppm during the measurement window. All other zones remained within the indicator range.

Carbon monoxide (CO)

What it is and why we measure it: Carbon monoxide is a colorless, odorless gas formed by incomplete combustion — vehicle exhaust, gas-fired appliances, and generators. Because it is an acute hazard that reduces the blood's ability to carry oxygen, even low indoor readings are screened to rule out combustion sources migrating into occupied space (for example from loading docks, an attached garage, or a flue that is not venting properly).

Observed: CO was uniformly low (0.4–1.1 ppm) and well below the US EPA NAAQS (9 ppm, 8-hour) and the OSHA PEL (50 ppm, 8-hour TWA). The slightly higher break-room reading (Zone 12-B, 1.1 ppm) is consistent with intermittent toaster/appliance use and is not of concern at this level.

Thermal comfort — temperature & relative humidity

What it is and why we measure it: Dry-bulb temperature and relative humidity together define the thermal environment, which is the single most common driver of occupant comfort complaints. Relative humidity also affects air quality: sustained high humidity can support microbial growth, while very low humidity contributes to dryness and irritation of the eyes and airways. Both are screened against the ASHRAE 55 comfort envelope.

Observed: Temperatures (70.2–74.9 °F) and relative humidity (36–51%) fell within the ASHRAE 55 comfort envelope for the season and clothing assumptions. The interior conference room trended to the warm/humid edge during occupancy, consistent with the elevated CO₂ and reduced air exchange noted above.

Fine particulate (PM_{2.5})

What it is and why we measure it: PM_{2.5} refers to airborne particles 2.5 micrometers and smaller — fine enough to be inhaled deep into the lungs. Indoor sources include cooking, printing, and outdoor particles drawn in through the ventilation system. It is measured as an indicator of particulate exposure and of how effectively the building's air filtration is performing.

Observed: PM_{2.5} ranged 6–18 µg/m³ (site mean 11 µg/m³), below the US EPA NAAQS 24-hour standard of 35 µg/m³. The copy/print room (Zone 8-F, 18 µg/m³) and break room (Zone 12-B, 16 µg/m³) were advisory-tier relative to quieter office zones, attributable to laser-printer and cooking activity respectively. These are local, intermittent sources rather than a building-wide condition.

Total volatile organic compounds (TVOC)

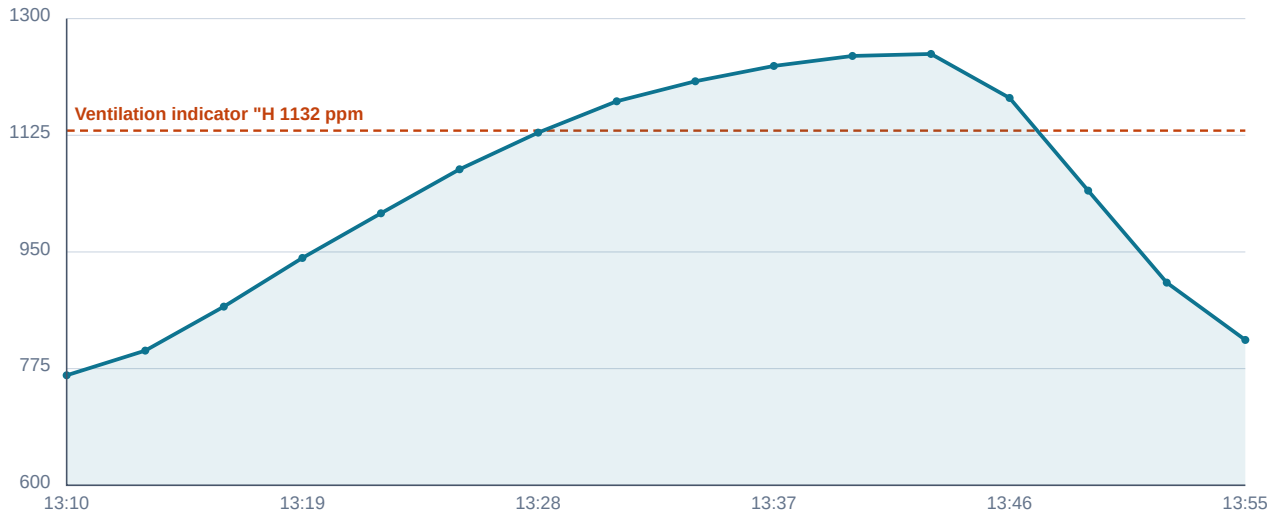
What it is and why we measure it: Total volatile organic compounds (TVOC) is a combined measure of the many gas-phase chemicals that off-gas from furnishings, finishes, adhesives, cleaning products, and office equipment. It is a non-specific screening indicator — it does not identify individual compounds — but elevated readings often accompany odor or irritation complaints and point to a source worth investigating.

Observed: TVOC ranged 220–610 µg/m³ (isobutylene-equivalent; site mean 368 µg/m³). Per the Mølhave (1991) advisory framework, the copy/print room (610 µg/m³) and conference room (520 µg/m³) fall in the lower "multifactorial exposure range," where irritation or comfort complaints become possible in sensitive individuals but no specific health effect is established. TVOC by photoionization is a non-specific comfort indicator only; it does not identify individual compounds or establish toxicological significance.

3.1 Continuous Logger Data (Logger Studio)

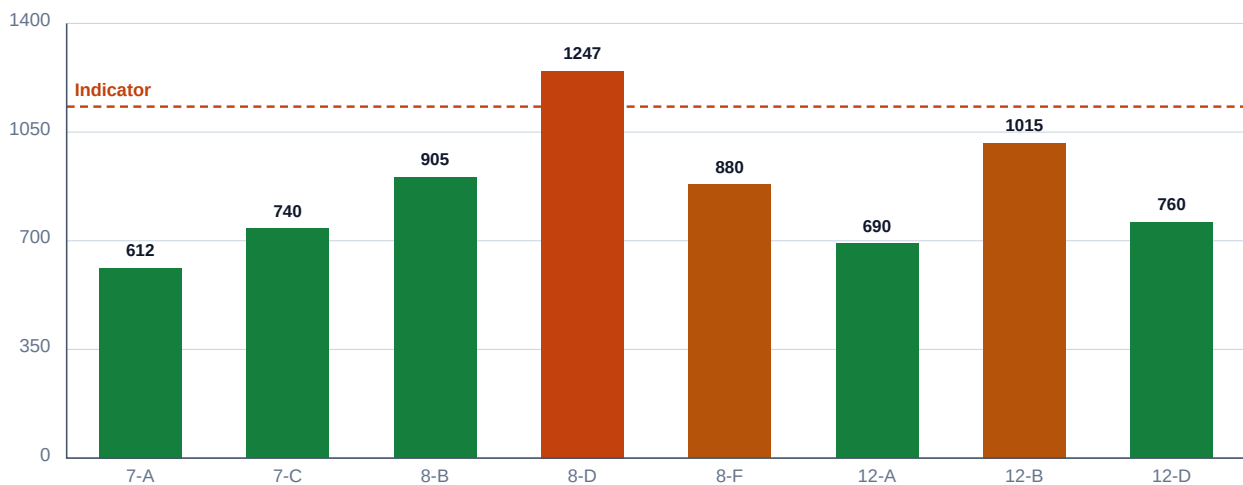
Beyond the grab readings above, a data logger captured CO₂ at one-minute intervals in the interior conference room (Zone 8-D) across a six-person meeting. AtmosFlow Logger Studio charts the series and overlays the ventilation-indicator threshold. The trend shows concentrations climbing through the occupied period and recovering once the room cleared — the signature of outdoor-air delivery lagging occupant load.

Figure 2 — CO₂ trend, Zone 8-D conference room (1-min logger)



Logger Studio export. Peak 1,247 ppm at ~13:43 during the meeting; baseline recovery within roughly ten minutes of adjournment.

Figure 3 — Peak CO₂ by zone vs. ventilation indicator



Across the eight zones, only the interior conference room (8-D) exceeds the ventilation indicator; every other space falls below it.

4. Findings & Interpretation

Findings are screening observations, ranked by recommended response. Each is tied to the zone and the governing indicator. No finding constitutes a regulatory exposure determination.

Zone	Severity	Screening finding
8-D	Elevated	CO ₂ of 1,247 ppm during a six-person meeting indicates under-ventilation of the interior conference room relative to occupant load.
8-F	Advisory	PM _{2.5} (18 µg/m ³) and TVOC (610 µg/m ³) elevated relative to office baseline, consistent with laser-printer emissions and limited local exhaust.
12-B	Advisory	CO ₂ (1,015 ppm) and PM _{2.5} (16 µg/m ³) elevated during break/meal periods; intermittent cooking source with shared return air.
8-D	Advisory	TVOC (520 µg/m ³) in the lower multifactorial range, co-located with the ventilation finding above.
All others	Acceptable	Ventilation, comfort, CO, particulate, and VOC indicators within recognized screening references at the time of assessment.

PROBABLE CONTRIBUTING FACTORS

- Interior zones on Floor 8 share a common VAV branch; balancing appears weighted toward perimeter loads, leaving the windowless conference room short on outdoor-air delivery at peak occupancy.
- Local emission sources (laser printing, food preparation) are served by general return air rather than dedicated local exhaust, allowing transient particulate / VOC excursions to mix into adjacent spaces.
- No evidence of water intrusion, visible microbial growth, or combustion spillage was observed during the walkthrough.

5. Recommended Actions

IMMEDIATE (0–7 DAYS)

- Increase outdoor-air supply to Floor 8, Zone 8-D during occupied hours. Verify VAV damper position and economizer operation through the building automation system (BAS).
- Until balanced, relocate meetings of more than four persons to perimeter conference rooms with higher supply capacity.
- Confirm the copy/print room (8-F) door-undercut and any transfer-air path; if a local exhaust fan is present, verify it runs during business hours.

SHORT TERM (7–30 DAYS)

- Conduct a CO₂-tracer ventilation survey of Floor 8 with a 4-hour logging instrument during normal occupancy. Cross-reference against as-built mechanical drawings to confirm Zone 8-D meets ASHRAE 62.1 Table 6.2.2.1 for Conference/Meeting space (5 cfm/person + 0.06 cfm/ft²).
- Re-balance the Floor 8 interior VAV branch; re-measure CO₂ and supply airflow after adjustment.
- Evaluate adding dedicated local exhaust or a standalone HEPA unit for the copy/print room.

MEDIUM TERM (30–90 DAYS)

- Add continuous CO₂ sensors to Zones 8-D and 12-B and log through one full HVAC seasonal cycle; establish per-zone baseline mean and 95th-percentile values.
- Integrate the new sensors with the BAS to enable demand-controlled ventilation where occupancy varies substantially across the week.
- Document as-designed versus as-installed ventilation rates in the building O&M records, and schedule a follow-up screening after corrective work.

6. Quality Assurance / Quality Control

- Instruments bump-checked the morning of the assessment; factory calibration within the prior 12 days and within manufacturer specification.
- PM2.5 monitor zeroed against a HEPA filter immediately before fieldwork; CO2 verified against fresh outdoor air at the rooftop intake.
- Grab readings held to stabilization (at least 3 minutes) before recording; the conference-room reading captured during a representative occupied meeting.
- All readings and field notes were recorded in AtmosFlow and reviewed against the reference framework by the assessor of record.

7. LIMITATIONS

This assessment is screening-level. Findings are based on direct-reading instrumentation captured during a single assessment window and reflect conditions on the assessment date only. No laboratory-analyzed integrated samples, microbial sampling, or destructive investigation were performed. Occupant counts and activity levels were observed at the time of measurement; sustained higher-occupancy or different operating conditions could produce different concentration profiles. Direct-reading TVOC and PM2.5 are non-specific comfort indicators and do not identify individual compounds or establish toxicological significance. This report does not constitute a regulatory exposure determination, an OSHA compliance certification, or a medical evaluation, and should not be relied upon as such.

8. PROFESSIONAL REVIEW & SIGNATURE

The undersigned has reviewed the measurements, findings, and recommendations in this report and asserts professional judgment on the screening interpretations and the prioritized actions in Section 5.

John Smith, CIH, CSP

Certified Industrial Hygienist · Certified Safety Professional
Prudence Safety & Environmental Consulting, LLC
Report ID PSEC-IAQ-2026-0314-MCT · March 14, 2026

Appendix A — Standards & References

Reference	Basis of use
ASHRAE 62.1-2022	Ventilation and Acceptable Indoor Air Quality. Used as the ventilation-indicator basis for CO2 interpretation (prescribes airflow, not a CO2 limit).
ASHRAE 55-2020	Thermal Environmental Conditions for Human Occupancy. Comfort envelope for temperature and relative humidity.
US EPA NAAQS (40 CFR 50)	National Ambient Air Quality Standards. CO 9 ppm (8-hr); PM2.5 35 µg/m³ (24-hr).
OSHA 29 CFR 1910.1000	Permissible Exposure Limits. CO PEL 50 ppm (8-hr TWA); CO2 PEL 5,000 ppm (8-hr TWA, industrial context).
Mølhave, L. (1991)	Volatile organic compounds, indoor air quality and health. Advisory TVOC comfort/irritation tiers; non-specific indicator only.
Persily, A. (2021)	Development and application of an indoor CO2 metric. Clarifies CO2 as a ventilation indicator, not a contaminant limit.

APPENDIX B — ABOUT THIS SAMPLE

AtmosFlow is a screening-only IAQ assessment platform: it captures field observations and direct-reading measurements, screens them against recognized references, and assembles a consultant-grade, defensible report for review by a qualified industrial hygienist or EHS professional. It identifies risk indicators and produces prioritized follow-up — it does not make regulatory classifications or compliance determinations. This sample uses fictitious data to illustrate structure and tone. Learn more at atmosflow.net.

Appendix C — Site Photographs

The photographs below are sample placeholders. A live AtmosFlow report embeds the assessor's geotagged field photos — each tied to the zone and finding it documents (for example, the windowless conference room, the rooftop intake, and the print-room printers referenced in Sections 3 and 4).



Photo 1. Interior conference room (8-D)

Windowless; logged during a six-person meeting



Photo 2. Rooftop fresh-air intake

Outdoor reference / economizer station

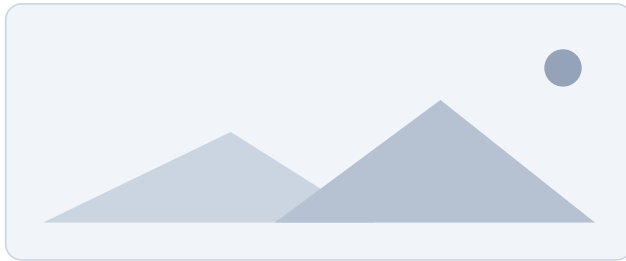


Photo 3. Copy / print room (8-F)

Laser printers; limited local exhaust

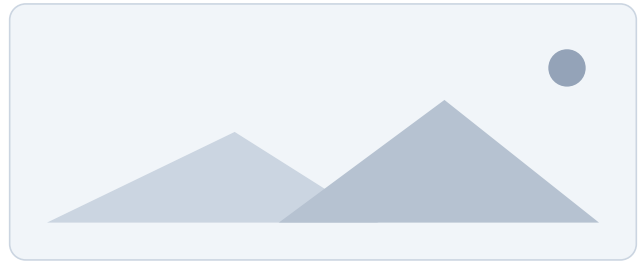


Photo 4. Break room (12-B)

Shared return air; intermittent cooking